Slang and idioms

TASK 1

Do you speak slang?

Talk with a partner.

1. Do you use slang in your own language? With whom?
2. Who uses the most slang in your country? Why?
3. Do you know any English slang? Where did you learn it?

TASK 2

Two kinds of sick

Read the two dialogues. What does *sick* mean in each? Is it positive or negative? Who are the speakers?

1

A: What seems to be the problem?

B: I've felt sick since last night.

A: Did you eat anything unusual?

B: Some fish that smelled a bit strange.

2

A: Did you see the game last night?

B: No! Did we win?

A: Four–one. And the last goal was *sick*.

B: No way!

In dialogue 1, *sick* means... _____

In dialogue 2, *sick* means... _____

Adapted from: Babbel, slang and idioms lesson material (babbel.com). Dialogues, sentences and tasks written for this lesson by Ramy Sakr for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 3

Seven slang words

Guess, then **match** each word to its meaning.

1. **wicked** _____
2. **wrecked** _____
3. **chill** _____
4. **stan** _____
5. **fit** _____
6. **lowkey** _____
7. **mint** _____

a. extremely tired (or very drunk)
b. attractive (British)
c. excellent, really good
d. perfect; in excellent condition
e. calm down; relax
f. a little, or secretly
g. to be a huge fan of someone

TASK 4

Use the slang

Complete each sentence with a word from Task 3.

1. Calm down, it's only a game. Just _____ out! _____

2. I danced until four in the morning, so I'm totally _____ today. _____

3. My sister has posters of the band all over her room. She really _____s them. _____

4. I'm _____ worried about the exam, but don't tell anyone. _____

5. Have you heard their new song? It's _____! _____

6. He's been going to the gym every day. He's looking really _____. _____

7. My grandad's old bike is still in _____ condition. _____

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TASK 5

Six idioms

Read the sentences. **Match** each idiom in bold to its meaning.

1. The tickets sold out in an hour. If you didn't buy one on Monday, you **missed the boat**. _____

2. Failing that exam was **a blessing in disguise**: I found a course I really love. _____

3. It's his first day here. **Cut him some slack**. _____

4. The party **got out of hand** when two hundred people turned up. _____

5. **To make a long story short**, we missed the plane. _____

6. Working from home two days a week gives me **the best of both worlds**. _____

a. to lose a chance because you were too late

b. something bad that turns out to be good

c. to be less hard on someone

d. to become impossible to control

e. to say it quickly, without all the details

f. the good parts of two different things

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TASK 6

Where would you say it?

In pairs: would you use each word or idiom with friends, at work, or both?

wicked | wrecked | chill | stan | fit | lowkey | mint

miss the boat | a blessing in disguise | cut someone some slack

get out of hand | to make a long story short | the best of both worlds

TASK 7

Ask and answer

Talk with a partner.

1. When did something turn out to be a blessing in disguise for you?
2. When did you last miss the boat?
3. Is there anyone you stan? Why?
4. When should people cut their teachers some slack?
5. What does the way you speak say about you?

TASK 8

Guess the word

In groups: choose a word or idiom from the lesson. Explain it without saying it. The others guess.

TASK 9

Role play

In pairs, choose a situation. Use as many words and idioms from the lesson as you can.

Two friends in their twenties talk about their favourite bands and shows.

Two colleagues discuss a rumour that two people from the office are dating.